

DAWs vs Magda: Feature Gaps & Beginner-Simple Music Creation

Subtitle: Competitor pattern map, prioritized Magda-gap shortlist, and beginner UX patterns for Logan's Magda-based app.

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1. Front matter

Disclaimer (print on every practical / shortlist section)

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Claim-class key

Class	Meaning
OBS Magda	Observed in Magda docs / product surfaces (as locked in adjudication)
OBS peer	Observed in competitor / peer first-party docs
Background	Seed / baseline context (not treated as full OBS inventory)
INT	Interpretation / scoring hygiene (including C–D–K–F–A)
Proposal	Recommendation for Logan's Magda-based beginner app
Unavailable	Explicitly disclosed gap; do not invent details

Method rules carried forward

- OBS ≠ Must-add** — “competitor has X” is not auto-Must; score C–D–K–F–A first.
- Patterns ≠ chrome** — catalog clip grids, song starters, scale snap; do **not** treat FL/Ableton/Apple/BandLab distinctive layouts as copy targets.
- Magda DNA spine** — Session + Arrange + Mix, hybrid tracks, auditable agents/DSL are keepers; beginner UX should scaffold them, not bury them under FL-parity or black-box song gen.

Verifier note (AUDIT_RV1 polish): BandLab Palette Help live reopen hit Cloudflare; cite Help article + GF-3 saved extract, not a fresh live-scrape narrative (**P1**). Prefer FL Channel Rack manual + Compare Editions matrix over JS-heavy FL Cloud marketing page body for Free vs Plus/Pro library axis (**P2**).

2. North star + anti-patterns

2.1 North star (LOCKED)

Question: What do modern DAWs (especially FL Studio and peers) do that Magda does not (or does weakly), which of those gaps are worth adding to Logan's Magda-based beginner app, and which UX patterns make music creation as simple as possible for an absolute beginner?

Short answer (LOCKED): Keep Magda's **Session + Arrangement + Mixer** triad, **hybrid tracks**, **auditable agents/DSL**, **Drum Grid / Chord Engine**, **Mix Analyze agent**, and **media AI** as the beginner spine — do **not** chase FL Channel Rack / Pattern ↔ Playlist parity or Suno-class black-box song gen. The largest beginner gap is **time-to-first-sound / guided first session** (Magda First Session is blank-page), not a missing Session View. Lock Must-class Proposal = guided first sound; agent-as-coach with visible DSL; Session-first → Arrange commit; Drum Grid + Chord Engine front door; progressive Mix. Prefer constrained creators, thin starters, and progressive disclosure. Success metric = finish a short song (≈60–90s), not feature-count parity or expert gatekeeping.

Pointers: Brief; MERGE §1–5; GAP_FILL_v1; PS-C-001–052; RM-C-001–015; CE-C-001–008, 040–082.

2.2 Beginner simplicity themes (NS-1–NS-5)

#	Theme	Locked rule	Pointers
NS-1	Fast first sound	Templates / Sounds-first gates / Loop Starter-class / Live Loops starter grids beat empty projects. Magda First Session fails this → M1 Must .	PS-C-028, 033–035, 038–041; RM-C-003, 007, 012; CE-C-007, 044; GF1-C-001–004
NS-2	Constrained creators	Touch Instruments / Drummer / Drum Grid / scale snap / small curated device set beat unbounded plugin malls.	PS-C-029, 034; CE-C-002, 006; RM-C-010
NS-3	Progressive disclosure	Show Session <i>or</i> Arrange first; faders before sends; notes before LFO envelopes; power remains reachable — not a permanent toy mode.	RM-C-006; CE-C-003–004, 070-class, 075; MERGE M5/D8
NS-4	Magda AI as auditable coach, not black-box	NL → editable DSL / param deltas / hear before-after; score unaided edit after AI; SongStarter-as-Must banned.	RM-C-014; CE-C-040–043; PS-C-009, 042
NS-5	Success metric	Finish a short song (≈60–90s), not expert gatekeeping or feature-count parity.	CE-C-008 (INT/Proposal)

2.3 Anti-patterns (Do-not import)

Anti-pattern	Why banned day-1	Pointers
FL Channel Rack ↔ Pattern ↔ Playlist dualism	Multi-plane overload; Magda is Ableton/Bitwig/Logic Live Loops family	CE-C-001, 054; RM-C-004; PS-C-024–027
"Just clone FL" / Suite parity chase	Failed beginner strategy; chrome/IP risk	CE-C-005; PS-C-051
Unbounded VST / "more plugins than FL (~118)"	Hick's / overchoice	CE-C-002, 055-class
Pro send/bus/sidechain maximalism before fader literacy	Cognitive overload	CE-C-003
Opaque full-song AI / Suno-class / SongStarter-as-Must	Hides DSL/session; learning-harm analogy	CE-C-040–043; PS-C-042; RM-C-014
Agent swarm without visible conductor	MAS failure mode if memory fragments	CE-C-046–051; MERGE D6/S6
Cloud account / BYOAK wall before first sound	Friction on Magda differentiator; local GGUF OK	CE-C-060-class; PS-C-009
Permanent Simple Mode that hides Mix Analyze / Session / DSL	Logic Simplified trap; wastes measurement agent	CE-C-070-class, 075, 081
Distinctive UI chrome clones (FL/Ableton/Apple/BandLab)	Patterns only — not legal advice	PS-C-051; RM-C-011
Timeline-only Reaper clone that orphans Session	Clashes Magda DNA	CE-C-052; RM-C-010

NOT legal advice. Patterns ≠ chrome.

3. Magda OBS baseline vs peer pattern map

3.1 Magda DNA spine (OBS Magda — scaffold, don't bury)

Verifier reopen (AUDIT_RV1 V2) confirmed against live Magda docs:

- **Session (clip launcher) + Arrangement + Mixer** triad — idea sketch → commit → balance.
- **Hybrid tracks** — removes audio-vs-MIDI track-type decision for beginners.
- **Auditable DSL + /dsl console** — NL → internal DSL; coach can show actions (anti-black-box).
- **View-routed specialists** (Drummer, Mixer, Session) — DNA keepers that need a **conductor-thread UX** (S6), not “cut agents.”
- **Drum Grid** (per-pad chains) + **Drummer agent; Chord Engine** + arp + step sequencer + prompt-to-pattern.
- **Chord Track** — project-level harmonic **guide** (≠ Engine; not audio output; drag suggestions to Track or Piano Roll). Already-has.
- **Mix Analyze** → **mixing agent** (measurement-grounded) — teach mix without routing maze; keep reachable under M5.
- **Media library + AI similarity / semantic search** — content discovery without FL Cloud clone.
- **Stem separation** (HPSS / Demucs / Spleeter; Intel macOS HPSS-only FLAG) + **take recording + swipe comping** (audio+MIDI) — already-has keepers; polish discoverability / Nice; **not** day-1 Must-build; not First Session hero.
- **Param hide / Mini FX / macros / Learn mode; local GGUF / llama.cpp; MCP read-only-until-grant.**
- Manual contract: **not a smash-hit factory** (PS-C-042) — align product copy.

Family placement (INT): Magda sits in the **Ableton / Bitwig / Logic Live Loops** cluster (Session + Arrange dual sequencers), **not** the FL Channel Rack → Pattern ↔ Playlist first family. Do not import FL's multi-plane dualism as a fourth composition model beside Session+Arrange.

3.2 Magda First Session thinness (OBS Magda → locks M1)

Verifier V1 (live Magda First Session + Welcome Getting Started): observed path is New Project → Add Track → optional arm/record → footer Live / Arrange / Mix → Save. **Absent:** templates, Live Loops packed grids, Loop Starter—class generators, SongStarter, Learn to Play, packed starters. Getting Started TOC lists Installation + First Session only.

Disposition (LOCKED): First Session thinness = content gap **and** DNA-hide risk (CE-C-044): the blank path also fails to surface Session clips + readable DSL. Fix with guided first sound that lands a Session clip + visible DSL — **not** black-box audio gen. This locks **Must M1**.

3.3 Peer pattern cards (OBS peer — OBS ≠ Must)

NOT legal advice. Patterns ≠ chrome. Transfer design patterns only; do not clone distinctive UI.

Peer	Transferable pattern (OBS peer)	Magda adapt rule (Proposal)	Do-not fence
FL Studio — Loop Starter	Genre → optional Key → Dice / Lock / Generate → Send to Playlist; all editions ; Free vs Plus/Pro library depth; unused-audition cleanup FLAG	Feed M1 / S2 / N5 — genre-stack starter on Magda media AI; thin free pack ≠ FL Cloud clone	Not Channel Rack chrome; not FL Cloud clone (V5; GF2; AUDIT P2: prefer manual + editions matrix)
FL Studio — Channel Rack / Pattern↔Playlist	Multi-plane composition OBS	Optional thin 1:1 track↔mixer adapt only	D1 day-1 dualism banned; not primary metaphor

Peer	Transferable pattern (OBS peer)	Magda adapt rule (Proposal)	Do-not fence
Ableton Live — Session/ Arrange	Dual sequencers; Back-to-Arrangement tax documented (CE-C-053)	M3 Session-first + Arrange capture + hearing/commit coach	Must-pair dual-view quotes with tax; no Live chrome
Bitwig — Clip Launcher / Next Actions	Dual sequencers; Next Actions; Switch/ Return to Arranger (UG 5.2 / extracts)	Refine S6 coach wording only	No Bitwig chrome Must; do not invent 6.1 UG coaches (Unavailable)
GarageBand / Logic — Smart* / templates / Learn to Play	Constrained instrument UIs; Sounds-first / template gates; tutorial depth	N3 / N2 patterns; supports constrained creators	Named GB Mac Project Templates = Unavailable first-party — do not invent names as OBS
BandLab — SongStarter	Strong OBS time-to-music peer	Adapt as guided first idea → editable Session clips + DSL	D5 reject opaque stereo-master Must; pair PS-C-042
BandLab — Palette	Membership-gated AI multi-layer loops (≤5) → Studio; genre/BPM/Key	Nice N5b loop-match; Magda emit = Session clips + DSL, not stereo master	Palette ≠ SongStarter ; D5 survives (V6; cite GF-3 extract / Help — AUDIT P1)
REAPER / timeline-only	Deep timeline power	Progressive disclosure behind Session	D10 do not orphan Session with timeline-only clone

Every peer row above is evidence for scoring — **not** auto-Must. Shortlist classes below are **Proposal**.

4. Locked shortlist — Logan’s Magda-based beginner app (Proposal)

Disclaimer (practical section): Design research only — **NOT legal advice**. Patterns ≠ trademarks / distinctive UI chrome. Proposal ≠ upstream Magda roadmap. OBS competitor/Magda facts are evidence pointers, not auto-ranking. Scored with RM **C–D–K–F–A** (RM-C-001) as **INT hygiene**; Must/Strong/Nice/Do-not = **Proposal**.

4.1 Must-add (LOCKED) — count: 5

#	Candidate	Why locked	Pointers
M1	Guided first session / time-to-first-sound (one-tap drums + bass + chord loop or genre/kit starter or constrained coach prompt “make an 8-bar beat”)	Magda First Session stays thin (empty project → track → record → views); no templates / Loop Starter / Touch Instruments / SongStarter. GF-1 H4 SUCCESS locks M1. Attach CE-C-044: thinness also hides DNA (Session/DSL/AI) — fix with clip + readable DSL, not black-box audio gen.	PS-C-028, 034–035, 038–041; GF1-C-001–004; RM-C-007, 012; CE-C-007, 044; GAP_FILL H4
M2	Agent-as-coach — constrained beginner prompts + visible audible DSL / “what changed” (not silent full-song gen)	Magda DNA differentiator; CE PNAS/TUM as analogous learning-science (not Magda-measured music RCT); prefer param deltas / hear before-after / unaided-edit success.	PS-C-009–010, 042, 049–050; RM-C-005, 014; CE-C-040–043; RM-XR XR-1
M3	Session-first default → Arrangement “capture / commit jam” with Back-to-Arrange / hearing-Session-vs-Arrange teaching	Dual-view is DNA and Ableton-class tax (CE-C-053); First Session ignores Session. Bitwig Next Actions / Switch to Arranger refine coach wording only — not chrome copy.	PS-C-003–004, 020–022; GF3-C-006–011; RM-C-013, 007; CE-C-053; GAP_FILL H3
M4	Drum Grid + Chord Engine (+ Sampler kit) as primary beginner instruments	Already Magda OBS — productize as front door , do not invent from scratch. Invert AI scaffolding toward beginner verbs (extend / design to Drum Grid/Sampler/FX — Nice N6). Chord Track ≠ Engine (Track = already-has project harmonic guide).	PS-C-006, 015; GF1-C-011–015; RM-C-007; CE-C-045; GAP_FILL H6
M5	Progressive Mix disclosure — faders / pan / mute / solo first; sends / spectrum later; Analyze remains reachable (not permanently hidden)	Mixer toggle rail OBS; hide-sends default = Proposal , not shipped Magda OBS. D8: no permanent Simple Mode that traps / hides Analyze.	PS-C-016, 048; RM-C-006; CE-C-003, 070-class, 075, 081; PS-XR-RM-05

4.2 Strong-add (LOCKED)

#	Candidate	Pointers
S1		

#	Candidate	Pointers
	Curated loop/sample packs + key/tempo filters on Media Library (content/UX layer on Magda media AI — not FL Cloud clone; thin free pack + optional larger library; cleanup unused auditions FLAG)	PS-C-017, 031, 034; GF2-C-001–005; RM-C-008; PS-XR-RM-04
S2	Scene / song-starter / section templates (thin Beat / Song / Blank — not overstuffed)	PS-C-033, 035; RM-C-008; CE-C-007
S3	Simplified piano-roll mode (draw + snap + scale/key lock)	PS-C-029; RM-C-008, 015; CE-C-004
S4	One-button bounce / share export; autosave / undo expectations	PS-C-047; RM-C-008
S5	Expose QWERTY MIDI + one shared spatial return / one-knob FX presets before full Faust bank	PS-C-047; RM-C-008; CE-C-003
S6	Session→Arrange graduation coach + conductor-thread agent UX (one visible plan; view tools not view memory). Bitwig “one active sequencer per track + switch back” = wording only.	RM-C-013; CE-C-046–049; GF3; GAP_FILL must-hold 6; RM-XR XR-2

4.3 Nice-if-scope (LOCKED)

#	Candidate	Pointers
N1	Live Loops–style packed starter grids (content-heavy polish)	PS-C-033, 035; RM-C-009
N2	In-app interactive tutorial tour (BandLab Show Tutorial class)	PS-C-040; RM-C-009
N3	Smart/constrained instrument UIs (GarageBand Touch/Smart <i>pattern</i> * — not chrome; named GB Mac templates remain Unavailable first-party)	PS-C-034; GF2-C-006–009; RM-C-009
N4	Collab / cloud share later (BandLab-class — product strategy, not Magda-core DNA)	PS-C-038; RM-C-009; CE-C-060-class
N5	Loop Starter–style dice randomize using Magda media AI similarity	PS-C-028, 017; RM notes N3; GF2
N5b	Palette-class loop-match (constrained genre/key/BPM → editable layered loops into Session) — membership-gated peer pattern; Magda emit = Session clips + DSL, not stereo master. Palette ≠ SongStarter . Do not invent Nice from MusicTech \$14.95.	GF3-C-001–005; PS-XR-RM-03; CE-XR-07; GAP_FILL H2
N6	Extend sound-design agent to Sampler / Drum Grid / FX (invert CE-C-045)	PS-C-012; CE-C-045; MERGE §6

4.4 Do-not-add / defer (LOCKED)

#	Candidate	Pointers
D1	Raw FL Channel Rack + Pattern ↔ Playlist as primary metaphor / day-1 dualism (don't add FL Pattern/Playlist as a fourth composition model beside Session+Arrange)	PS-C-024–026; RM-C-004, 010; CE-C-001, 054; RM-XR XR-6
D2	“Just clone FL” / Suite feature-parity roadmap	CE-C-005; RM-C-010; PS-C-051
D3	Unbounded VST / “more plugins than FL (~118)” day-one (prefer small curated set — “handful” Proposal, not science-locked “exactly 7”)	CE-C-002, 055-class; RM-C-010; RM-XR XR-4
D4	Pro send/bus/sidechain maximalism before fader literacy	CE-C-003; RM-C-006
D5	Opaque full-song AI / Suno-class black-box / SongStarter-as-Must hero path (Palette ≠ SongStarter — loop-match may be Nice N5b)	PS-C-042; RM-C-014; CE-C-040–043; GAP_FILL must-hold 5
D6	Agent swarm without visible conductor; MCP multi-writer / OSC as day-one beginner path	CE-C-046–051; MERGE S6
D7	Account/social wall or cloud BYOAK before first sound / first AI action — local GGUF / llama.cpp OK and preferred day-1	CE-C-060-class; PS-C-009; RM-XR XR-5
D8	Permanent Simple Mode that traps users and hides Mix Analyze / Session / DSL	CE-C-070-class, 075, 081
D9	Copy FL/Ableton/Apple/BandLab trademarks or distinctive UI chrome	PS-C-051; RM-C-011
D10	Faust-experiment / Grid-depth DSP as onboarding; timeline-only Reaper clone that orphans Session	CE-C-052; RM-C-010

4.5 Magda-already-has keepers (do not reinvent / do not “simplify” away) (LOCKED)

Keeper	Role in beginner story	Pointers
Session + Arrangement + Mixer triad	Idea sketch → commit → balance	PS-C-003–004; CE Magda-native keepers
Hybrid tracks	Removes audio-vs-MIDI track-type decision	PS-C-005; RM notes §1.2
Auditable DSL + /dsl console	Coach shows actions; anti-black-box	PS-C-009; RM-C-005, 014; CE-C-040

Keeper	Role in beginner story	Pointers
View-routed specialists (Drummer, Mixer, Session) — if exposed as one conductor	DNA; needs UX conductor (S6)	PS-C-010; CE-C-047; RM-XR XR-2
Drum Grid (per-pad chains) + Drummer agent	Primary beginner beat path (M4 productize)	PS-C-006, 010
Chord Engine + arp + step sequencer + prompt-to-pattern	Harmonic / pattern scaffolds (M4 front door)	PS-C-015
Chord Track (project-level harmonic guide ; ≠ Engine; not audio output; drag suggestions to Track or Piano Roll)	Already-has / Strong polish discoverability — do not invent Must-build chord track	GF1-C-011–015; PS-C-046; GAP_FILL H6; PS-XR-RM-02
Mix Analyze → mixing agent (measurement-grounded)	Teach mix without routing maze; keep reachable under M5	PS-C-016; CE-C-081
Media library + AI similarity / semantic search	Content discovery without FL Cloud clone	PS-C-017
Stem separation (HPSS / Demucs / Spleeter; Intel macOS HPSS-only FLAG) + take recording + swipe comping (audio+MIDI)	Already-has keepers — polish discoverability / Nice; not day-1 Must-build; not First Session hero	PS-C-018–019; GF1-C-005–010; GAP_FILL H1; PS-XR-RM-01; CE-XR-09
Param hide / Mini FX / macros / Learn mode	Progressive disclosure already claimed	PS-C-048
Local GGUF / llama.cpp option	AI without account wall (supports D7 nuance)	PS-C-009; CE-C-060-class
MCP read-only-until-grant	Safe connectivity posture	PS-C-011; CE-C-050
Manual contract: not a smash-hit factory	Align product copy (PS-C-042)	PS-C-042

Critical distinctions (must travel with every practical section):

- **Chord Engine** = M4 front door (productize existing device). **Chord Track** = already-has project guide — do **not** invent “Must add chord track.”
- **Stems + take/comp** = already-has; Nice discoverability only; not First Session hero.
- **Palette ≠ SongStarter**: D5 bans opaque full-song / SongStarter-as-Must; N5b allows membership-gated loop-match emitting editable Session clips + DSL.
- **First Session is thin** (OBS) — that thinness locks M1; do not claim Magda already ships templates / Loop Starter.

NOT legal advice. Patterns ≠ chrome.

5. Beginner simplicity brainstorm

5.1 Themes applied to Magda

NS-1 Fast first sound. Magda’s Session View already exists (OBS); First Session simply does not use it. The highest-leverage beginner move is a one-tap path that places a playable Session clip (drums + bass + chords, or genre/kit starter, or constrained coach “make an 8-bar beat”) **and** shows a readable DSL snippet of what was done. That simultaneously closes the time-to-first-sound gap and surfaces DNA that blank-page First Session currently hides (CE-C-044).

NS-2 Constrained creators. Prefer Drum Grid + Chord Engine + a small curated Sampler kit as the front door (M4), with scale/key lock on a simplified piano roll (S3). Curated device set = “handful” **Proposal** — do **not** lock “exactly 7” as science (RM-XR XR-4). Unbounded VST mall remains **D3**.

NS-3 Progressive disclosure. Session *or* Arrange first (M3 Session-first default); faders before sends (M5 Proposal default — OBS is toggle rail, not shipped hide-sends); notes before LFO envelopes. Power remains one tap away — **D8** bans permanent Simple Mode that hides Mix Analyze / Session / DSL.

NS-4 Auditable coach. Magda’s NL → DSL path (OBS) is the differentiator when framed as **agent-as-coach** (M2): constrained beginner prompts, visible “what changed,” param deltas, hear before-after, and a success check of unaided edit after AI. Pair every AI marketing unit with PS-C-042 (“not a smash-hit factory”). PNAS

Bastani / TUM CS1 cites are **analogy** → **design rule**, not Magda-measured music RCT — do not print “–17% music skill” as OBS (RM-XR XR-1).

NS-5 Success metric. Finish a short song ≈60–90s (INT/Proposal, CE-C-008) — not feature-count parity with FL Suite, not expert gatekeeping.

5.2 Magda-specific opportunities

- 1. **Guided first sound that emits Session + DSL** — closes M1 and teaches the dual-view spine without FL Pattern/Playlist.
- 2. **Conductor-thread agent UX (S6)** — keep view specialists; one visible plan; view tools not view memory. Do **not** “cut agents” because swarm risk exists (RM-XR XR-2); require conductor UX instead (D6 fences swarm without conductor).
- 3. **Invert AI scaffolding (N6)** — extend sound-design agent toward Drum Grid / Sampler / FX (CE-C-045); don’t demo AI only on hard synths / 4OSC full tabs (those stay behind progressive disclosure).
- 4. **Media AI as content layer (S1 / N5 / N5b)** — curated packs + key/tempo filters; optional dice randomize; optional Palette-class loop-match into Session — all emitting editable clips + DSL, never opaque stereo master.
- 5. **Local GGUF first (D7 nuance)** — prefer local model default so first sound / first AI action has no cloud account or BYOAK wall; optional BYO cloud later.

5.3 SongStarter tension (minority preserved)

BandLab SongStarter is a strong OBS time-to-music peer pattern. **Adapt** as guided first idea emitting **editable Session clips + DSL**; **reject** opaque stereo-master Must (D5). Palette is a separate peer pattern (N5b loop-match) — do not collapse Palette into a SongStarter ban (PS-XR-RM-03; CE-XR-07). Always pair SongStarter/ Palette discussion with PS-C-042 in the same unit.

NOT legal advice. Patterns ≠ chrome.

6. Counterevidence fences

These fences are **Proposal** Do-not / design rules grounded in CE + OBS peers. They travel with every practical shortlist section.

Fence	Rule	Key pointers
FL dualism	Do not add Pattern/Playlist as a fourth composition model beside Session+Arrange day-1	D1; CE-C-001, 054; RM-XR XR-6
Clone-FL parity	Do not roadmap Suite feature-count parity	D2; CE-C-005; PS-C-051
VST mall	No unbounded plugin mall day-1; curated handful Proposal (not “exactly 7” science)	D3; CE-C-002; RM-XR XR-4
Pro routing first	No send/bus/sidechain maximalism before fader literacy	D4; CE-C-003
Black-box song AI	No Suno-class / SongStarter-as-Must hero; Palette ≠ SongStarter (N5b OK)	D5; CE-C-040–043; PS-C-042
Agent swarm	No swarm without visible conductor; don’t cut Magda agents — require conductor UX	D6; S6; RM-XR XR-2
Account / BYOAK wall	No cloud account or paid key before first sound / first AI; local GGUF OK	D7; RM-XR XR-5
Permanent Simple Mode	Progressive ≠ permanent; Analyze / Session / DSL one tap away	D8; M5; CE-C-075, 081
Chrome clones	Patterns only — FL / Ableton / Apple / BandLab / Bitwig distinctive UI not copy targets	D9; PS-C-051; RM-C-011
Orphan Session / Faust onboarding	No timeline-only Reaper clone; no Faust/Grid-depth DSP as onboarding	D10; CE-C-052

Fence	Rule	Key pointers
Dual-view tax	Every Ableton/Bitwig dual-sequencer quote carries Back-to-Arrangement / hearing coach	M3; CE-C-053; GF3
Inverted scaffolding	Don't demo AI only on hard synths; extend toward Drum Grid/Sampler/FX	N6; CE-C-045
Learning-harm analogy scope	PNAS/TUM = analogy → show DSL/deltas / score unaided edit — not Magda music RCT	M2; RM-XR XR-1
IP / expression	Not legal advice; do not copy trademarks or distinctive UI expression	PS-C-051; disclaimer

Discarded overclaims (do not print as OBS requirements): Magda First Session already has templates; Must-build stems/comping/chord track from scratch; Chord Track = Chord Engine; clone FL Channel Rack as primary metaphor; SongStarter black-box as Must; Palette = SongStarter (ban all BandLab AI); “Magda AI hurts music learning 17%” as OBS; cut Magda agents; exactly 7 devices as science; require cloud BYOAK / ban local AI; permanent Simple Mode; named GB Mac templates as OBS; Magda interactive demo reliability numbers.

NOT legal advice. Patterns ≠ chrome.

7. Uncertainty & Unavailable disclosures (LOCKED)

Item	Status	Editor / product rule
Magda interactive product demo / in-app stems-comping reliability	Unavailable FLAG (GF1-C-010; PS gap 7)	Do not invent reliability numbers; do not require demo to lock already-has docs
GarageBand Mac named Project Templates	Unavailable first-party (GF2-C-006)	Keep GB pattern class ; do not print invented template names as OBS
Bitwig Studio 6.1 revamped full UG	Still being prepared (GF3-C-012); 5.2 PDF + live HTML used	Do not invent 6.1 coaches; cite 5.2/HTML OBS only
Exact FL Cloud Free-tier sample counts	Marketing variance FLAG (GF2)	UX rule = Free starter vs Plus/Pro larger — no invented counts (AUDIT P2: prefer manual + editions)
Loop-pack licensing for GPL Magda-based app	Out of scope	Not legal advice — label only if mentioned
MERGE §1.2 Palette Cloudflare / Bitwig UG 409	Superseded by GF-3 SUCCESS	Print Observed via GF3; clear stale Unavailable (annotate — do not overwrite PS ledger). AUDIT P1: BandLab Help live Cloudflare this pass — cite GF-3 extract / Help article
Hands-on FL Loop Starter / BandLab membership UI	Docs-only in GF-2/3	Sufficient for pattern lock; do not invent UI chrome details

Claim IDs in this report are **pointers** into lane ledgers — reopen primaries for quotes; **no invented citations**.

8. Source appendix — claim-ID index

Claim IDs are pointers only. Reopen lane ledgers / primaries for verbatim quotes. **No invented citations**. Lane ledgers were **not** overwritten by this report.

Cluster	Claim IDs (pointers)	Role in this report
Magda DNA / views / hybrid / agents	PS-C-003–011, 015–017, 048, 052	Keepers; north star; M2–M5
First Session thinness	PS-C-041; GF1-C-001–004; CE-C-044	Locks M1
Stems + take/comp	PS-C-018–019; GF1-C-005–010	Already-has keepers
Chord Track vs Engine	PS-C-015, 046; GF1-C-011–015	M4 vs already-has Track
FL Loop Starter / editions / cleanup	GF2-C-001–005, 010; PS-C-028	Patterns → M1/S2/N5
BandLab Palette	GF3-C-001–005	Nice N5b; ≠ SongStarter

Cluster	Claim IDs (pointers)	Role in this report
Bitwig UG / Next Actions	GF3-C-006–012	S6 coach wording only
SongStarter / anti-smash-hit / IP	PS-C-042, 051	D5; disclaimer travel
Learning-science analogy	CE-C-040–043; RM-XR XR-1	M2 design rule scope
Agent conductor / swarm	CE-C-046–051; RM-XR XR-2	S6 / D6
Dual-view tax	CE-C-053	M3 must-pair
Progressive Mix / Simple Mode	CE-C-003, 070-class, 075, 081	M5 / D8
Scoring hygiene	RM-C-001–002, 011	OBS≠Must; Proposal labels
Verifier reopen paths	AUDIT_RV1 V1–V15; polish P1–P2	APPROVE; BandLab/FL source grain

GAP_FILL dispositions folded (H1–H6): H4 First Session → lock M1; H1 stems/comping → already-has; H6 Chord Track ≠ Engine; H5 Loop Starter → patterns only; GF2 GB Mac → patterns / Unavailable names; H2 Palette → Nice N5b ≠ D5; H3 Bitwig → refine S6 only.

XR blocking across PS-XR / RM-XR / CE-XR: 0. Material folds applied in locked shortlist (ADJ §4; AUDIT V15).

9. End matter

Editor must-holds checklist (all 20 — applied in this report)

1. High-stakes disclaimer on front matter and every shortlist/practical section: **not legal advice**; patterns ≠ trademarks / distinctive UI chrome; Proposal ≠ upstream Magda roadmap. ✓
2. Magda DNA spine kept: Session+Arrange+Mix; hybrid tracks; auditable agents/DSL; Drum Grid/Chord Engine; Mix Analyze; media AI — scaffold, don't bury. ✓
3. Must M1–M5 locked as **Proposal** (guided first session; agent-as-coach + visible DSL; Session-first→Arrange; Drum Grid/Chord Engine front door; progressive Mix). ✓
4. Magda-already-has table printed in full (incl. stems+comping; Chord Track ≠ Engine; local GGUF; DSL). ✓
5. Chord Engine = M4 front door; Chord Track = already-has — no “Must add chord track.” ✓
6. Stems + take/comp = already-has; Nice discoverability only; not day-1 Must / not First Session hero. ✓
7. **Palette ≠ SongStarter**: D5 opaque full-song / SongStarter-as-Must Do-not; N5b Palette-class loop-match Nice. ✓
8. Loop Starter / GB Smart / *Learn to Play* / *Bitwig Next Actions* = *transferable patterns only* — *no chrome*; *Loop Starter all-editions + Free vs Plus/Pro + unused-audition FLAG*; *not FL Cloud clone*. ✓*
9. Do-not printed: FL Pattern/Playlist day-1; VST mall; clone-FL parity; opaque song AI; permanent Simple Mode; chrome clones; cloud BYOAK before first sound (**local GGUF OK**). ✓
10. C–D–K–F–A = INT hygiene; Must/Strong/Nice/Do-not = Proposal — never typeset as OBS Magda defaults. ✓
11. Mixer: OBS = toggle rail; Proposal = faders-first; Analyze remains reachable (D8 fence). ✓
12. AI learning cites (PNAS Bastani; TUM CS1) = analogy → design rule, not Magda-measured music RCT. ✓
13. Agent path: conductor-thread UX required; do not “cut agents.” ✓
14. Curated device set = “handful” Proposal — not “exactly 7” as science. ✓
15. Ableton/Bitwig dual-view quotes carry Back-to-Arrangement / hearing coach; Session-first + commit jam. ✓
16. Invert AI scaffolding toward Drum Grid/Sampler/FX (N6); don't demo AI only on hard synths. ✓
17. Success metric ≈60–90s finished song = INT/Proposal. ✓

18. Unavailable items (§7) disclosed. ✓
19. Claim IDs are pointers; no invented citations. ✓
20. MERGE §1.2 stale Palette Unavailable / Bitwig UG 409 cleared → GF-3 Observed at Editor (ledgers not back-written). ✓

Verifier handoff status

Item	Status
ADJUDICATION_v1	LOCKED
AUDIT_RV1	APPROVE (0 blockers; polish P1–P2 folded)
This report	editor/REPORT_v1.md + editor/Magda_DAW_Beginner_Feature_Gaps.pdf (inspected)
Lane ledgers	Not edited
Next	RV-2 spot-check vs locks (per ADJ §9 / AUDIT handoff)

Closing

For Logan's Magda-based beginner app: keep the Magda DNA spine; close the blank First Session with guided first sound that lands Session clips + visible DSL; productize Drum Grid + Chord Engine as the front door; teach Session→Arrange with a hearing/commit coach; disclose Mix progressively while keeping Analyze reachable; use agents as an auditable coach under a conductor thread; treat peer DAWs as **pattern** sources only. Do not chase FL Channel Rack dualism, Suite parity, VST malls, opaque full-song AI, permanent Simple Mode, or chrome clones. **Stems, comping, and Chord Track are already-has** — polish discoverability, don't reinvent. **Palette ≠ SongStarter**. Success = a beginner finishes a short song, not feature-count parity.

Disclaimer (end matter): Design research synthesis only — **NOT legal advice**. Does not grant permission to copy trademarks, unique UI chrome, or distinctive expression of FL Studio / Ableton / Apple / BandLab / Bitwig / peers. Licensing / GPL / forking notes are labels only, not legal opinions. Recommendations are **Proposal** for Logan's Magda-based beginner app — **not** upstream Magda roadmap commitments. Feature patterns are transferable design patterns, not chrome to clone.

End REPORT_v1 — RE-1 from ADJUDICATION_v1 (LOCKED) + AUDIT_RV1 (APPROVE). Patterns ≠ chrome. Palette ≠ SongStarter. First Session thin. Stems/comping/Chord Track already-has.